Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 25th October 2026

Parish Clergy: Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

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Gospel Reflection *(Matthew 22:34-40)*

In today's gospel, Jesus teaches that the greatest commandment is to love God wholeheartedly and to love our neighbour as ourselves. These two responsibilities are inseparable and form the foundation of Christian life.

Loving God involves more than religious practices such as prayer, worship, and Scripture reading. It means trusting Him in difficult times, remaining faithful through challenges, choosing what is right, and allowing Him to guide every aspect of our lives. Genuine love for God is shown not only in words but also in daily actions.

Our love for God becomes visible in how we treat others. We cannot truly love God while harming, judging, or refusing to forgive those around us. Instead, we are called to show compassion, kindness, patience, and mercy. Even simple acts such as listening, encouraging, forgiving, and helping those in need can become powerful expressions of God's love.

Jesus also calls us to recognize the dignity and worth of every person, including those who differ from us or disappoint us. True love does not ignore wrongdoing, but it speaks the truth with respect and sets boundaries without hatred.

The central message of this Gospel is that love must be at the heart of both our relationship with God and our relationship with others. Faith is not measured by religious knowledge or activities alone, but by whether it transforms us into more loving people. When love guides our thoughts, words, and actions, our lives become a living witness to God's presence in the world.

May the Lord bless us with hearts open to love. May He help us to see Christ in one another and to bring kindness, hope, and compassion wherever we go.

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 4th November at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy of the family and friends of

Maureen McCrossan, Innisfree Gardens, Strabane;

Rosemary Donnell, Mount Bernard Rise, Castlederg;

Anne O'Donnell, Coolatee, Lifford

Anniversaries Sean Carlin, Margaret Daly, Thomas Daly, Margaret Devine, Jenny Doherty, John Doherty, Brad Doherty Snr, Ann Farry, Raymond Foley, Kathleen Gamble, Catherine Hannigan, Tony Hannigan, Stim Hughes, Patrick Kennedy, Paschal McCallion, Tommy McDaid, Edie McDermott, Alex McDonald, Kathleen McGill, George McGinley, Rose McGrath, Pam McLaughlin, Bridie McMenamin, Eileen Porter, Tony Stewart. Rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick £1,163.91 (£549 Missions)

Clonleigh €1,726.23 (€275.61 Missions)

Camus £1,645.97, (£636.33 Missions)

Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 1st November (All Saints):

1st Reading: Revelation 7:2-4, 9-14;

Psalm: 24:1-2, 3-4, 5-6;

2nd Reading: John 3:1-3;

Gospel: Matthew 5:1-12

Saints of the Coming Week:

Tuesday St Otteran, monk;

Wednesday: St Simon and St Jude, Apostles;

Thursday St Colman of Kilmacduagh, bishop;

Friday St John of Capistrano, priest;

Saturday St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

Please Note that from Monday 2nd November, weekday Mass at **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road** will be at **7.45 am**. We wish to remind all parishioners that the **Vigil Mass** at **St Patrick's, Murlog** is now at **6.00 pm**, until further notice. We thank you all for your co-operation and understanding.

Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group: Golden Jubilee Day of Prayer, **Praise and Healing,** celebrating 50 years takes place on Sunday 15th November in the Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh. Registration: 9.30 am, concluding with Mass in the afternoon. Theme: People of God's Delight (Ps 194.4). Speaker: Fr John Keane. Cost £40 (includes coffee and lunch). Please contact Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041 by 1st November to book (for catering purposes).

Parish Draw The October parish draw for Camus / Leckpatrick takes place on Thursday 29th October at 7.30 pm in the parochial house, Ballymagorry. Please return outstanding payments to your promoter or to the parish office. Good luck.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses Dates: 29th/30th January, 19th/20th February & 19th/20th March 2027 are now available to book. Please visit www.accordni.com Courses are in person in Everglades Hotel, Derry.

Class Act Theatre Group presents *Fame The Musical* at St Patrick's Hall, Strabane, from 2nd – 6th November. This exciting production will showcase the talents of almost 100 local young people, providing a wonderful opportunity for the community to support and celebrate local talent on stage. Audiences can look forward to an energetic and uplifting performance featuring a large cast of dedicated young performers. Given the popularity of previous Class Act productions, early booking is strongly recommended. Tickets can be booked online via www.classacttheatregroup.co.uk/events

St Patrick's, Dungannon Charismatic Prayer Group: Golden Jubilee Event: Saturday 5th December, at the Servite Priory, Benburb, commencing at 11.00 am and concluding with Mass at 3.00 pm. Everyone is welcome to this 50th celebration, with theme "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come."

Pray for Vocations St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "… with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel…" We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

The Next Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours will take place on Tuesday 3rd November and 1st December from 8 – 9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Considering a Vocation to the Diocesan Priesthood? There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood in Derry on Sunday 8th November at 4.00 pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

Abide Women's Conference from 20th – 22nd November at Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Dominicans, etc. Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, Cork & Ross diocese. Please visit Abide in His Love at Eventbrite.ie. Registration at https://abide inhislove.eventbrite.com

The Columban Young Adults is a relatively new group for those aged 18 – 35 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our November event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on **Thursday 19th Nov at 7.00 pm** at Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. We are seeking new members. Please come along and bring a friend! For information, please contact columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend takes place in St Mary's, Knock, Co Mayo from Friday 9th – Sunday 11th April 2027. This residential weekend starts at 7.30 pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30 pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

Praying for the Holy Souls Our Lady of Montligeon Prayer Group meets on Wednesday 28th October from 12.30 pm – 1.30 pm at Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Annual Solemn Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00 pm, beginning this Sunday, 25th October. The theme of our Novena this year is 'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'. Each night will comprise of the Rosary, Novena prayer and petitions with a short talk given by various guest speakers and Eucharistic Healing Ceremony with Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament. We encourage everybody, including those in particular need of healing to join us. Join us also via https://longtowerchurch.org/webcam/

Job Opportunity St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry is recruiting an experienced Choir Director (10 hours per week) to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir, ensuring that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description / application pack, please contact (028) 71262302 / recruitment@derrydiocese.org Completed applications must be submitted to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP or to recruitment@derrydiocese.org by noon on Thursday 12th November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. Applications from men and women and from members of all communities welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meetings resume on Mondays at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four in St Pat's Hall on Thursdays at 8 pm. Some fun, excitement and slight competition. Everyone welcome.

NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Centre 2000, 21-27 Moyle Rd, Newtownstewart, BT78 4AP on 30th Oct from 12.30 – 4 pm & 5 – 7 pm. Visit https://nibts.bookinglive.com/book/add/p/6 / tel 08085534653.

A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett from Fri 6th – Sun 8th November at Termonbacca, An opportunity for prayer, reflection and to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or Termonbacca Derry | Derry | Facebook

Gamblers Anon Tel 71351329. **Alcoholics Anonymous** Tel 90351222.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: 4.30 pm; Sunday: 11.00 am

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: 12.15 pm

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.00 pm**; Sunday: 9.45 am

St Mary's Cloughcor: Sunday 8.30am (25th Oct – alternate Sundays – 8th Nov)

St Joseph's Glenmornan: Sunday 8.30am (1st Nov – alternate Sundays – 15th Nov)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am**: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am**: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am**: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am**: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, **27 Butcher St, Strabane** covers all 3 parishes**. Office hours:** Monday – Thursday 9.30 am – 4.30 pm; Friday 9.30 am – 12.30 pm.

Feel free to call in or phone on 028 71882215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays. **A Small Collection of Candles, Mass cards / Mass bouquets** available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

St Pio prayer cards alsoavailable.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash /cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995.

Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23.